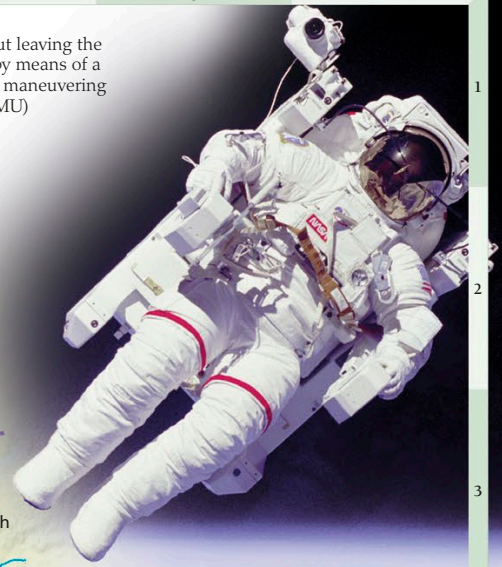




ADOBE HOUSES

Traditional homes of the Pueblo peoples of the Southwest were made from adobe bricks of sun-baked earth and straw covered with plaster. Dwellings had a flat roof and smooth walls. Modern adobe-style buildings can still be seen in the Southwest, but are often made of concrete and then painted to look like adobe. Here, a woman demonstrates baking bread in an adobe oven.

Astronaut leaving the shuttle by means of a manned maneuvering unit (MMU)



NASA

Houston, Texas, is the center of the United States space program. After a rocket has blasted off from Cape Canaveral in Florida, its journey is controlled by the National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA) from Houston. Astronauts are also trained at the center and new space technology is developed here.

The Grand Canyon is up to 1 mile (1.6 km) deep, 18 miles (29 km) wide, and stretches for 217 miles (349 km).



OIL FIELDS

The oil industry has provided Texas with much of its wealth. Oil lies deep underground and is brought up to the surface by massive oil jacks, known as nodding donkeys.

Gulf of Mexico

SPANISH INFLUENCE

Close to Mexico and Central America, the Southwestern states have long been settled by Hispanic people, whose influence can be seen—and heard—throughout the Southwest. Spanish is widely spoken, and the Roman Catholic religion that the Spanish brought is evident in the churches scattered throughout the region.

